Confrontation

By Mary Krell-Oishi

LEANNA: Well, this is fun. What ever possessed me to come to this party is a mystery to me. (She pulls a small compact from her purse.) So glad I took the time to have my roots done so I could impress all these people I don't give a damn about. (Yelling) I hate everyone here!

BRANDON: (He enters on her last line.) Oops, sorry...Leanna? Is that you?

LEANNA: Brandon. Of course. Why wouldn't it be you? It's been a lousy party, a lousy day, and now, to add insult to injury, you come in. Thank you, God. You're a funny guy.

BRANDON: Ah. Carrying around some unresolved conflicts from your past?

LEANNA: And you're talking to me because...?

BRANDON: Sorry, I just poked my head in for a minute.

LEANNA: Well, then, why don't you just poke it back out.

BRANDON: It's been a long time.

LEANNA: Not nearly long enough.

BRANDON: Uh-huh. Well, I'm glad we had this chance to talk, to renew old friendships. I'll just be going.

LEANNA: Go to hell, Brandon.

BRANDON: Ah, still thinking of opening the Leanna MacDonald school of how to win friends and influence people?

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INTRODUCTION

Actor: Brandon and Leanna had a brief relationship in high school.
Actress: Meeting each other at a party five-years later was the last thing that either one expected.
Actor: High school memories of football games, dances and crushes are, for some, the best memories of our lives.
Actress: For others the memories are much less pleasant.
Together: And therein lies the basis for this Confrontation by Mary Krell-Oishi.

LEANNA: Please, sit down, stay a while. I need more crap in my life.

BRANDON: What is with you? This is a party, lots of people you haven't seen in a long time, good food, good music, nice memories. It's supposed to be a fun thing, you know?

LEANNA: Go to hell, Brandon.

BRANDON: You are a piece of work, aren't you?

LEANNA: Look who's talking. Why don't you get the hell out of here?

BRANDON: You invited me to stay.

LEANNA: You can't hear sarcasm?

BRANDON: Hey, I just came in to find my fiancee. I can see she's not here, so I'll just be on my way.

LEANNA: Your fiancee? You're getting married?

BRANDON: That surprises you? I'm over twenty-one.

LEANNA: But to make that kind of commitment. To actually be there for someone other than yourself.

BRANDON: Listen, you've obviously got some unresolved problems that have nothing to do with me and everything to do with your own screwed-up mind. I haven't seen you in years, I said hello, you said go to hell,I think our conversation has run its course.

LEANNA: Witty as you always were. Quite the little wordsmith, aren't you? Of course, I don't remember us doing that much talking 10 those many years ago.

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BRANDON: Jeez, Leanna, that was how long ago?

LEANNA: Five years, seven months, two weeks and three days.

BRANDON: (Uncomfortably taken aback) Oh...I didn't realize...

LEANNA: Please, I made that up. It's been about five years. I haven't been counting the days since last we touched, trust me.

BRANDON: Oh. I didn't think you had. I mean...never mind.

LEANNA: God, there is just no end to your ego, is there? Your name should be Axis, you seem to think the world revolves around you.

BRANDON: You seemed to think it did, way back when.

LEANNA: Brandon, I was barely fifteen. I was stupid. Only someone as stupid as a fifteen-year-old would get that wrapped up in someone as shallow and superficial as you. Most women grow up and expect to marry a man, not a worm. So did you meet your fiancee on the playground? Still cruising around looking for innocents?

BRANDON: I want to know what your problem with me is. We haven't seen each other in years, yet you act like I murdered your family yesterday. So, we made love a long time ago...

LEANNA: We didn't make love. I made love, you had sex...

BRANDON: OK, it was sex.

LEANNA: What surprises me is that I actually thought it was love. It's what you told me.

BRANDON: I was a kid myself. I would have said anything to get what I wanted. What are you still so upset about?

LEANNA: It meant something to me. It still does.

BRANDON: Well, get past it.

LEANNA: I can't.

BRANDON: What do you want from me? You want me to lie to you and say it meant something special? I was in high school. I'm sorry that you got caught in the

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fallout. Accept my apologies and move on.

LEANNA: That's all it was to you. You are pathetic. You take a little girl and use her. That, no doubt, is what you're going to end up doing to that poor girl you intend on marrying.

BRANDON: I love Sarah.

LEANNA: You told me you loved me, as I recall.

BRANDON: I never told anyone else I loved you. Hey, when you're a kid you say what you have to say to get what you want. I'm sorry. What do you want from me?

LEANNA: Nothing. You've got nothing to give me that can change anything.

BRANDON: If I could take it back, I would. But that was a long time ago.

LEANNA: You never even think about it, do you?

BRANDON: Honestly? No.

LEANNA: Hardly a day goes by that I don't.

BRANDON: It wasn't that big a deal, trust me.

LEANNA: It was for me. I thought I was someone important to you, that you cared. Obviously I was wrong. People, I've discovered, are only interested in what they want and everyone else be damned. And that is the basic fact of life.

BRANDON: (Beginning to become angry) No, sweetheart! The basic fact of life is if you don't talk, you can't expect anyone to know what's going on. And here's something else for you to think about. I didn't force you to do anything you didn't want to do. You were a more than willing accomplice, if memory serves.

LEANNA: Wrong! I was a child. What you did was practically rape.

BRANDON: Take some responsibility for your own actions. You were fifteen, I was seventeen. You could have said no.

LEANNA: So could you.

BRANDON: Oh, right. You invite me over to your house, your parents are gone for the night, and we end up in your room "watching TV." You know why I didn't call you? Because you were a little too easy. Ijust wasn't interested in a girl that

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would be so willing to give herself away.

LEANNA: That's a horrible thing to say.

BRANDON: Sometimes the truth is pretty ugly. Deal with it and get on with your life.

LEANNA: Get on with my life?! You have no idea how hard it has been to just "get on with my life!"

BRANDON: It was one time. One crummy time. My God, let it go.

LEANNA: That's so easy for you to say.

BRANDON: Yeah, it is. Why are you holding on to this? What is the big deal?

LEANNA: I got pregnant.

BRANDON: (Pause) What?

LEANNA: That one time, I got pregnant. That's what the big deal is.

BRANDON: You got pregnant? How? Never mind, stupid question. Why didn't you tell me?

LEANNA: I tried to. You wouldn't listen.

BRANDON: When? When did you try?

LEANNA: I came over to your house, I looked for you outside the school after your classes, I would wait for you in the parking lot. Hell, I even came to football practice and stood at the sidelines hoping to talk to you.

BRANDON: Why didn't you say something?

LEANNA: It's hard to talk to the back of a head. You would never look at me. You know as well as I do that you wanted nothing to do with me after you accomplished your goal of bedding me. I was a number to you. Well, my number got called.

BRANDON: What happened?

LEANNA: Now you're interested?

BRANDON: Yes, now I'm interested. I would have been then, too, if you'd given me a chance.

LEANNA: Oh no you don't. I tried to talk to you, dammit, I tried.

BRANDON: I was a kid, too. A male kid. You think I needed to have some cow-eyed girl

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follow me around making me feel guilty for taking her virginity?

LEANNA: You could have asked. But you didn't. Completely wrapped up in yourself. But even if you did and I told you, what would you have done?

BRANDON: Done?

LEANNA: Yeah, done. You know, a course of action, a plan? What would you have done?

BRANDON: I don't know.

LEANNA: Typical.

BRANDON: Dammit, Leanna. You spring this on me years and years after the fact and I'm supposed to come up with instant answers.

LEANNA: I knew then. You would think only of yourself and anyone who got in your way was simply a roadblock to be pushed through. You would have turned your back on me, admit it.

BRANDON: Would you have wanted me to marry you? With you at fifteen? And me on my way to college?

LEANNA: At least I would have had an option.

BRANDON: So would have I, but you took those away. What did you do?

LEANNA: What the hell do you think I did? I was alone, I had no choices. I had an abortion.

BRANDON: By yourself? You went through that by yourself?

LEANNA: Not completely.

BRANDON: Did you tell your parents?

LEANNA: No. Only one other person knows, the person that took me to have it. . . taken care of.

BRANDON: I should have been that person.

LEANNA: You're saying you would have been there for me? Don't make me laugh. I was so low on your list of priorities that I didn't exist.

BRANDON: Why do you think I'm such an ass? You might have been surprised.I can't guess what I would have done. I'd like to say that I would have been a good

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father and supported you both financially as best I could...

LEANNA: But...

BRANDON: But I honestly don't know. I was a high school jerk, one of those guys that they write as the fool on TV sitcoms. But I honestly don't think I would have let you go through it alone.

LEANNA: It's been my experience that we all end up alone when it comes time to count on someone. You proved that.

BRANDON: I proved nothing! I wasn't given a chance to prove myself. You could have tried. So you made all the choices, for me, about me, and without me.

LEANNA: Listen, I said what I had to say. I've carried it around for a long time, and now that it's out I guess I can let it go.

BRANDON: Yeah, you've carried it around for a long time. You just dumped this on me. I need to deal with it.

LEANNA: What's there to deal with? It happened to me, not to you.

BRANDON: It happened to both of us. You just didn't bother to share it.

LEANNA: I'm going to say this once, OK, and I don't want to go over it again. You made me pregnant when I was fifteen, you ignored me right after it happened, treating me as if I didn't exist. It was a problem I had to deal with in the best way a fifteen-year-old knows how. Maybe I should have had more faith in your nature, but I didn't. But basically, the facts are I carried this anger and hostility around for a long time and directed it at everyone I dealt with and everything I tried. My attitude was that I was alone and you reinforced that, directly or indirectly, it doesn't matter. And, yeah, maybe I should have tried harder to tell you, and maybe, just maybe, you would have been warm and compassionate. I doubt it, but we'll never know. The great thing is, I told you. You wanted me to get past it, to let it go? Well, maybe now I can.

BRANDON: So you dump this on me?

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LEANNA: Dump what? That you impregnated some stupid little girl who had a mad crush on you? I took care of the problem, Brandon. It's done with. And frankly, a day doesn't go by that I don't think about it and have more than a few regrets. But I have to tell you what an ass I always thought you were and finally the reason why. I've waited a long time to do this. God, I feel great.

BRANDON: I feel like crap.

LEANNA: Then my work here is done.

BRANDON: You don't feel the slightest remorse?

LEANNA: About the abortion? Yeah. But, from my point of view, I had no choice. I was fifteen and had to make some grown-up choices on my own.

BRANDON: What about the way you told me, the way you just screwed up my mind with your news?

LEANNA: Hello! This isn't about you. This is about me.

BRANDON: You could have counted on me, I'm sure of that. You could have.

LEANNA: Well, I'm sure you can't count on anyone except yourself, Brandon. I learned it early and remembered my lesson well.

BRANDON: You never gave me an opportunity to prove you wrong.

LEANNA: You're a funny guy. It's so easy for you to say this now, from a safe distance from the reality of the situation I actually dealt with. Trust me, you have no idea what you would have done. Or maybe you do..,and you can't face the fact of it. Maybe you're not the great compassionate guy you'd like to believe. Think about that one in about fifteen years or so when you and your little wifey have a daughter and she starts dating some cute seventeen-year-old guy who reminds you of yourself. Think about that, my friend. (She begins to exit)

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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